ART CARAVAN PH

# Inventory System Role-Based User Manual

Practical end-user guidance for secure, accurate, and auditable daily operations.

| | |
|---|---|
| ADMINISTRATOR | INVENTORY STAFF |
| SALES ASSOCIATE | SALES / MARKETING STAFF |

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End-user edition | Internal use

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Use this manual as a guided reference. Begin with the shared procedures, then continue to the chapter for your assigned role.


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| | |
|---|---|
| **Scope** | This manual covers end-user operation only. It intentionally excludes hosting, databases, deployment, source code, and infrastructure administration. |

# 1. About This Manual

A role-based guide to the everyday workflows that keep inventory, sales, approvals, and audit records accurate.

## Purpose and audience

The Art Caravan PH Inventory System supports controlled inventory movement and multi-channel sales across Head Office and store hubs. This manual is written for Administrator, Inventory Staff, Sales Associate, and Sales/Marketing Staff accounts. Each user should follow only the procedures available to their assigned role and store access.

## How to use the guide

1. Complete Chapter 2 before using any role-specific module.
2. Read the chapter matching your assigned account role.
3. Use the checklists before submitting high-impact transactions.
4. Contact an administrator when a required menu is hidden, a store assignment is missing, or an account is locked.

## Core operating principles

| Principle | What it means in practice |
|---|---|
| **Accuracy first** | Check store, date, item, condition, quantity, sales channel, and attachment before submission. |
| **Least access** | Use only the stores and channels assigned to your account. Hidden actions are intentionally restricted. |
| **Approval separation** | Submitting and verifying are separate responsibilities. Do not approve a transaction without reviewing its evidence. |
| **Audit clarity** | Use real references, meaningful remarks, and correct attachments so another user can understand the transaction later. |
| **Condition control** | Good and Damaged stock are different. Never substitute one condition for the other. |

# 2. Getting Started

Shared instructions for signing in, protecting your account, navigating the workspace, and ending a session safely.

## First-time sign-in and private password

1. Open the system URL supplied by your administrator.
2. Enter your employee ID or username and the temporary password.
3. When the Secure Your Account page appears, enter the temporary password again.
4. Create a new password with at least 12 characters, including uppercase, lowercase, number, and symbol.
5. Confirm the new password. It must be different from the temporary password.
6. Save the private password and continue to your dashboard.

**Password rule** Never share your password, reuse the temporary password, or allow another person to work under your account. System activity is recorded under the signed-in user.

## Sign-in attempts and account locking

The login page reports the remaining attempts after an incorrect password. Five unsuccessful attempts temporarily lock the account for 15 minutes. If the account remains unavailable, contact the administrator instead of repeatedly guessing.

## Navigation

| Area | Purpose |
|---|---|
| **Dashboard** | Summary of permitted stores, inventory health, pending tasks, and operational shortcuts. |
| **Sidebar** | Role-appropriate modules. Items may differ by role, store, and assigned sales channels. |
| **Notifications** | Updates about submissions, approvals, rejections, transfers, and requests requiring attention. |
| **Profile** | Review or update permitted personal account details. |
| **Sign out** | Ends the authenticated session. Always use it on shared devices. |

## Session safety

The system protects idle sessions. If your session expires, it returns to login. Save work promptly, avoid leaving an unfinished form open, and sign out before leaving the device. If another device takes over the session, verify that the sign-in was authorized and change the password if it was not.

# 3. Roles and Access

A quick reference for who performs each workflow. Actual access also depends on account status, assigned store hubs, and sales channels.

| Capability | Admin | Inventory | Sales Associate | Sales / Marketing |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **View dashboard and products** | Yes | Yes | Assigned stores | Assigned channels / stores |
| **Register and manage staff** | Yes | No | No | No |
| **Master data and store hubs** | Yes | Operational access | No | No |
| **Manage inventory and imports** | Yes | Yes | View / request | View |
| **Stock allocation** | Yes | Yes | No | No |
| **Record channel sales** | As assigned | No | Walk-In / assigned | Assigned channels |
| **Verify pending sales** | Yes | Yes | No | No |
| **Branch transfer request** | Manage | Manage / review | Submit | No |
| **Returns** | Manage | Manage | Branch workflows | Sales-status workflows |
| **Reports** | Broad access | Operational logs | Assigned stores | Assigned channels |

**Permission boundary**

A hidden action normally means your role, store, or sales-channel assignment does not authorize it. Do not attempt to bypass a hidden menu using a saved URL.

# 4. Administrator

Administration, access control, master data, oversight, and exception handling across the system.

## Administrator daily checklist

1. Review dashboard alerts, pending verifications, and operational notifications.
2. Check rejected or exception transactions that require correction or follow-up.
3. Review staff access, store assignments, and active status when responsibilities change.
4. Review staff activity and inventory transaction logs for unusual or incomplete activity.
5. Confirm that critical transactions have supporting references and attachments.

## Register a new staff account

1. Open Staff Directory and choose Register New Staff.
2. Enter the employee ID, full name, contact details, and other required identity information.
3. Assign exactly the role required for the employee's responsibilities.
4. Assign the correct store hub. For Sales/Marketing Staff, assign only authorized sales channels.
5. Set an initial temporary password and save the account.
6. Provide the employee ID and temporary password privately. The employee must create a private password at first login.

**Access control** Never grant Administrator access as a convenience. Use the narrowest role and channel assignment that allows the staff member to perform their work.

## Maintain staff accounts

| Action | When to use it | Required follow-up |
|---|---|---|
| **Edit** | Name, contact, role, branch, or channel assignment changed. | Ask the staff member to sign in again and confirm access. |
| **Reset password** | The user forgot the password or account security is in doubt. | Issue a temporary password privately; the user changes it at login. |
| **Deactivate** | Employment or access is suspended. | Verify that no shared workflow depends on the account. |
| **Reactivate** | Authorized access is restored. | Recheck role, store, and channels before activation. |
| **Delete** | Only when policy permits permanent account removal. | Review audit implications first; deactivation is usually safer. |

## Configure master data

Use Configuration to maintain store hubs, unit types, brands, departments, and groups. Before deactivating or deleting master data, check whether products, staff, or transactions depend on it. Prefer deactivation when historical records must remain understandable.

## Review and approve operations

1. Open the relevant pending queue or operational report.
2. Compare the request with order references, quantities, condition, store, and attachments.
3. Approve only when the evidence and available stock agree.
4. If rejecting, enter a specific reason that tells the submitter exactly what to correct.
5. Confirm the result in the transaction or staff activity log.

## Administrator reports and audit logs

Use reports to identify sales status, returns, replacements, refunds, inventory movement, and channel performance. Use staff activity logs to answer who performed an action and when. Do not edit live database records to correct an operational mistake; use the system's approved correction, return, rejection, or replacement workflow.

# 5. Inventory Staff

Inventory control, file processing, verification, allocations, transfers, pull-outs, returns, and condition-aware stock handling.

## Inventory Staff daily checklist

1. Review pending sales and inventory verification counts.
2. Check low-stock, critical-stock, and out-of-stock alerts.
3. Review queued product imports or exports and resolve failed requests.
4. Review transfer, return, Fully Booked, Event, and National pull-out activity.
5. Reconcile Good and Damaged quantities before ending the work period.

## Product catalog and store inventory

The shared catalog defines common product identity. Store inventory contains hub-specific quantities and status. Search by item ID, barcode, or description before creating or importing a product to avoid duplicates. Use the correct unit type, brand, department, and group.

## Import products

1. Open the target store hub and choose Import Products.
2. Download or use the approved workbook format. Do not rename required columns.
3. Check item IDs, descriptions, classifications, prices, stock, and condition values.
4. Upload the workbook and keep the import progress window open until the request is accepted.
5. Monitor the import status. Review processed, updated, skipped, and failed counts.
6. Correct rejected rows in the source workbook and submit a new import rather than duplicating successful rows.

| | |
|---|---|
| **Large imports** | Do not refresh, submit again, or start another import while the current request is processing. Duplicate submissions can create unnecessary workload and confusing audit entries. |

## Verify a pending sale

1. Open Verify Sales or the pending-sales queue.
2. Confirm the submitting staff member, store, channel, date, order number, and customer details.
3. Review each product, quantity, available stock, price, discount, and condition.
4. Open every required order slip, quotation, or payment proof.
5. Approve when details are complete and stock is valid. Stock is deducted only through the approved workflow.
6. Reject with a clear correction reason when the request is incomplete or inconsistent.

## Stock allocation

Stock allocation reserves Good stock for sales channels. Damaged stock is part of physical inventory but is not available for allocation. Before increasing a channel allocation, verify that unallocated Good stock is sufficient. Reducing an allocation does not create physical stock; it only releases reserved capacity.

## Transfers and restocks

1. Choose the correct movement: Head Office to Branch, Branch to Head Office, Branch to Branch, or Restock.
2. Select source and target stores carefully; they cannot represent the same location.
3. Add products, quantities, and condition details. Verify availability at the source.
4. Enter a meaningful reference and remarks, then submit.
5. For branch-to-branch requests, review and approve only after validating both locations and quantities.
6. Confirm the completed movement in Inventory Transactions.

## Returns and condition handling

| Return condition | Inventory effect | Required check |
|---|---|---|
| **Good** | Returns to Good physical stock; eligible channel allocation may also be restored. | Original sale, channel, item, and remaining returnable quantity. |
| **Damaged** | Returns to Damaged physical stock and is not allocatable. | Actual condition and remaining Damaged return quantity. |
| **Refund only** | Records financial resolution without restoring physical stock. | Confirm that no physical item was returned. |

# Fully Booked, Event, and National operations

Use the dedicated workflows for Fully Booked orders, sponsor/workshop activity, Event inventory, and National pull-outs. Review worksheets before import, preserve the correct activity type, and close an Event only after sales and returns have been recorded. Event returns are limited separately by product and condition; never convert excess Damaged quantity into Good quantity or the reverse.

| Workflow | Before submitting | Completion check |
|---|---|---|
| **Fully Booked** | Confirm order reference, item list, pull-out quantities, and supporting file. | Track fulfillment, returns, rejection, and remaining quantities. |
| **Event inventory** | Confirm event, pull-out condition, quantity, and responsible staff. | Record sales and condition-specific returns before closing the event. |
| **National pull-out** | Confirm destination, schedule, products, quantities, and evidence. | Verify the final status and retain a traceable reference. |

## Operational handover

1. Leave every active request with a clear reference, current status, and responsible next user.
2. Identify any quantity that is still pulled out, in transit, sold, returned, damaged, or awaiting verification.
3. Attach or identify the worksheet and supporting evidence used for the latest action.
4. Escalate differences before closing the activity; do not use a manual adjustment to hide an unresolved variance.

**Condition boundary** Good and Damaged quantities remain separate throughout pull-out, sale, and return processing. If the physical condition differs from the record, stop and escalate the discrepancy before completing the transaction.

# 6. Sales Associate

Branch-focused selling, transfer requests, returns, reports, and customer-facing transaction accuracy.

## Sales Associate daily checklist

1. Confirm the selected store hub before recording any transaction.
2. Review available products and stock before confirming a customer order.
3. Record Walk-In or other authorized sales with complete references and evidence.
4. Review rejected submissions and correct them promptly.
5. Check branch transfers, returns, Fully Booked requests, and notifications.

## Record an authorized sale

1. Open the assigned store hub and choose Record Walk-In or the available sales action.
2. Select the date and enter the required order or customer reference.
3. Search for each product and confirm available stock before entering quantity.
4. Enter price, approved discount, payment method, and other required details.
5. Attach the required payment proof or quotation evidence for the selected payment method.
6. Review totals, then submit for verification. Do not promise completed stock deduction until approval is recorded.

## Submit a branch transfer

1. Open Branch Transfer from the assigned hub.
2. Choose the destination branch and add the requested products.
3. Confirm quantities against the displayed source availability.
4. Enter a reference and business reason, then submit for Inventory Staff or Administrator review.
5. Monitor notifications and the transaction log for approval or rejection.

## Record a branch return

1. Open Return Items and find the original sale or eligible transaction.
2. Confirm the customer, channel, product, and remaining returnable quantity.
3. Enter Good and Damaged quantities separately based on actual inspection.
4. Select the correct resolution and enter remarks.
5. Submit and verify that the return appears in the appropriate report.

> **Do not guess** If the original sale cannot be found, the item condition is uncertain, or the remaining quantity is zero, stop and ask Inventory Staff or an Administrator to review the history.

## Reports and rejected submissions

Use store reports to review recorded sales, marketplace activity, branch returns, and authorized channel results. Rejected Sales lists submissions that require correction. Read the rejection reason, correct the underlying information, and resubmit only once.

# 7. Sales / Marketing Staff

Head Office and assigned-channel workflows for multi-channel sales, order status, Fully Booked activity, returns, replacements, refunds, and reports.

## Sales / Marketing daily checklist

1. Confirm assigned channels are visible and appropriate for current responsibilities.
2. Review pending, rejected, and status-sensitive channel orders.
3. Record new sales with complete customer, order, pricing, and proof information.
4. Follow up Fully Booked and return activity that requires action.
5. Review channel reports for incomplete payment, delivery, replacement, or refund details.

## Record a multi-channel sale

1. Open the Head Office store hub and choose Record Sale.
2. Select only a sales channel assigned to your account.
3. Enter the transaction date. Allow the system to generate or validate the channel order number.
4. Select or enter the customer name and required customer details.
5. Add products, verify available stock, and enter quantity, regular price, and approved discount.
6. Add required payment, quotation, order-slip, or channel evidence.
7. Review totals and submit for verification. Inventory changes occur through the verification workflow.

| | |
|---|---|
| **Channel access** | If Record Sale or a channel is hidden, your account is not authorized for it. Ask the Administrator to review the channel assignment; do not record the order under another channel. |

## Manage order status

Update only the status supported by actual fulfillment evidence. Use consistent references for packing, shipment, delivery, collection, cancellation, replacement, and refund activity. Status updates should tell the next user what has happened and what remains outstanding.

## Fully Booked requests

1. Open Fully Booked Order and provide the store, customer, order details, and requested items.
2. Attach the required order document and submit the request.
3. Monitor the request through review and pull-out stages.
4. If rejected, correct the reason shown and submit a new, complete request.
5. Record an eligible Fully Booked return against the original completed order.

## Returns, replacements, and refunds

| Workflow | Use when | Before submitting |
|---|---|---|
| **Return** | A physical item comes back. | Confirm original order, item, condition, quantity, and channel. |
| **Replacement** | An eligible item is exchanged. | Check original item, replacement availability, value difference, and proofs. |
| **Refund** | A financial reversal is authorized. | Confirm refund amount, payment method, reason, and whether stock returns. |
| **Additional payment** | Replacement value exceeds available credit. | Attach non-cash payment proof and record the correct difference. |

## Channel reports

Use the report that matches the original channel: Online, TikTok, Wholesale, Walk-In, Marketplace, or Fully Booked. Filter by store, date, status, or reference as available. Verify totals against the underlying order and open attachments only through the system's secure preview or download action.

# 8. Shared Transaction Standards

Rules that every role follows when recording inventory, sales, attachments, approvals, and corrections.

## Before submitting any transaction

| Check | Question to answer |
|---|---|
| **Store** | Am I working in the correct Head Office or branch hub? |
| **Channel** | Is this the original and authorized sales channel? |
| **Product** | Does the item ID, description, and unit match the physical item? |
| **Quantity** | Is the quantity within available or remaining eligible stock? |
| **Condition** | Are Good and Damaged quantities recorded separately? |
| **Money** | Do price, discount, payment method, refund, and difference agree? |
| **Evidence** | Are the correct, readable, and relevant files attached? |
| **Reference** | Can another user trace this transaction without asking me? |

## Attachment standards

1. Upload only the required order slip, quotation, payment proof, item image, or promotion proof.
2. Use a clear image or PDF with all relevant details visible.
3. Check that the attachment belongs to the current transaction and contains no unrelated private information.
4. Preview the file after upload when the form provides a preview action.
5. Do not upload executable files, edited evidence that changes meaning, or duplicate files without reason.

## Corrections

Correct mistakes through the system workflow: edit before submission, reject and resubmit when pending, or use an authorized return, replacement, refund, or status update after approval. Do not create an opposite transaction solely to hide an error and do not ask technical staff to alter records directly.

# 9. Notifications, Logs, and Accountability

How to respond to system messages and use records responsibly.

## Notifications

Notifications identify events that require awareness or action. Open the notification to reach its related record when available. Read the full message before acting, and avoid treating a notification count alone as proof that a transaction is complete.

## Activity and transaction logs

Logs preserve the actor, date, operation, and related details. Administrator and Inventory Staff views may include broader inventory logs; Sales Associate views are scoped to authorized branch activity. Logs support investigation and accountability and must not be treated as an editable worksheet.

## Escalation guide

| Situation | First response | Escalate to |
|---|---|---|
| **Wrong password / locked account** | Wait for the lock period; do not keep guessing. | Administrator |
| **Missing menu or store** | Confirm account role and selected hub. | Administrator |
| **Stock mismatch** | Stop the transaction and compare logs and physical count. | Inventory Staff / Administrator |
| **Rejected sale** | Read the reason and correct the original information. | Verifier if clarification is needed |
| **Missing attachment** | Confirm the correct transaction and retry through the form. | Administrator if the file remains unavailable |
| **Suspected unauthorized access** | Sign out and change the password immediately. | Administrator |

# 10. Troubleshooting

User-safe responses to common issues. Never attempt to fix a problem by editing database records or bypassing authorization.

| Message or symptom | What to do |
|---|---|
| **Session expired** | Return to login, sign in again, and reopen the workflow. Recheck unsaved fields. |
| **Account temporarily locked** | Wait 15 minutes or contact the Administrator. Do not continue guessing. |
| **Insufficient permission** | Confirm your role, assigned hub, and sales channels with the Administrator. |
| **Insufficient stock** | Reduce quantity or ask Inventory Staff to reconcile physical and system stock. |
| **Duplicate order number** | Verify the channel and original order. Do not create a modified duplicate reference without approval. |
| **Return exceeds remaining quantity** | Check earlier returns and enter only the remaining eligible quantity and condition. |
| **Import still processing** | Wait and monitor status. Do not submit the same file again. |
| **Attachment cannot open** | Confirm the file finished uploading, refresh once, and report the exact transaction reference. |
| **Unexpected page or error** | Record the time, page, action, and transaction reference; send them to the Administrator. |

# 11. Quick Reference

Compact checklists for use during training and daily operation.

## Submitter checklist

- Correct store and channel
- Correct customer and order reference
- Correct product, quantity, price, and condition
- Required attachments are readable
- Totals and remarks reviewed
- Submitted once

## Verifier checklist

- Submitter and store are authorized
- Order reference is valid and not duplicated
- Stock and condition are available
- Price, discount, payment, and totals agree
- Attachments support the request
- Approval or rejection reason is clear

## End-of-shift checklist

- Pending work reviewed
- Rejections and notifications addressed
- Imports are completed or properly handed over
- Physical discrepancies escalated
- No transaction left open on a shared device
- Account signed out

## Key terms

| Term | Meaning |
|---|---|
| **Good stock** | Sellable physical quantity that may support channel allocation. |
| **Damaged stock** | Physical quantity recorded separately and not available for allocation. |
| **Allocation** | Good stock reserved for a specific sales channel. |
| **Pending sale** | Submitted sale awaiting authorized verification. |
| **Hub** | Head Office or branch location used to scope inventory and operations. |
| **Fully Booked** | Dedicated Head Office order and pull-out workflow. |
| **Event inventory** | Items pulled out for an event, with separate sales and returns. |
| **Audit log** | System record of who performed an action and when. |

# 12. Training Acknowledgment

Use this page after role-based orientation and supervised practice.

I acknowledge that I received orientation for the Art Caravan PH Inventory System. I understand that I must use only my own account, follow my assigned role and store access, protect customer and transaction information, and report discrepancies instead of bypassing system controls.

| | |
|---|---|
| **Employee name** | |
| **Employee ID** | |
| **Assigned role** | Administrator / Inventory Staff / Sales Associate / Sales-Marketing Staff |
| **Assigned store hub(s)** | |
| **Assigned sales channel(s)** | |
| **Trainer** | |
| **Training date** | |
| **Employee signature** | |
| **Trainer signature** | |

**Document owner** Art Caravan PH system administration. Review this manual whenever workflows, permissions, or user-facing screens materially change.